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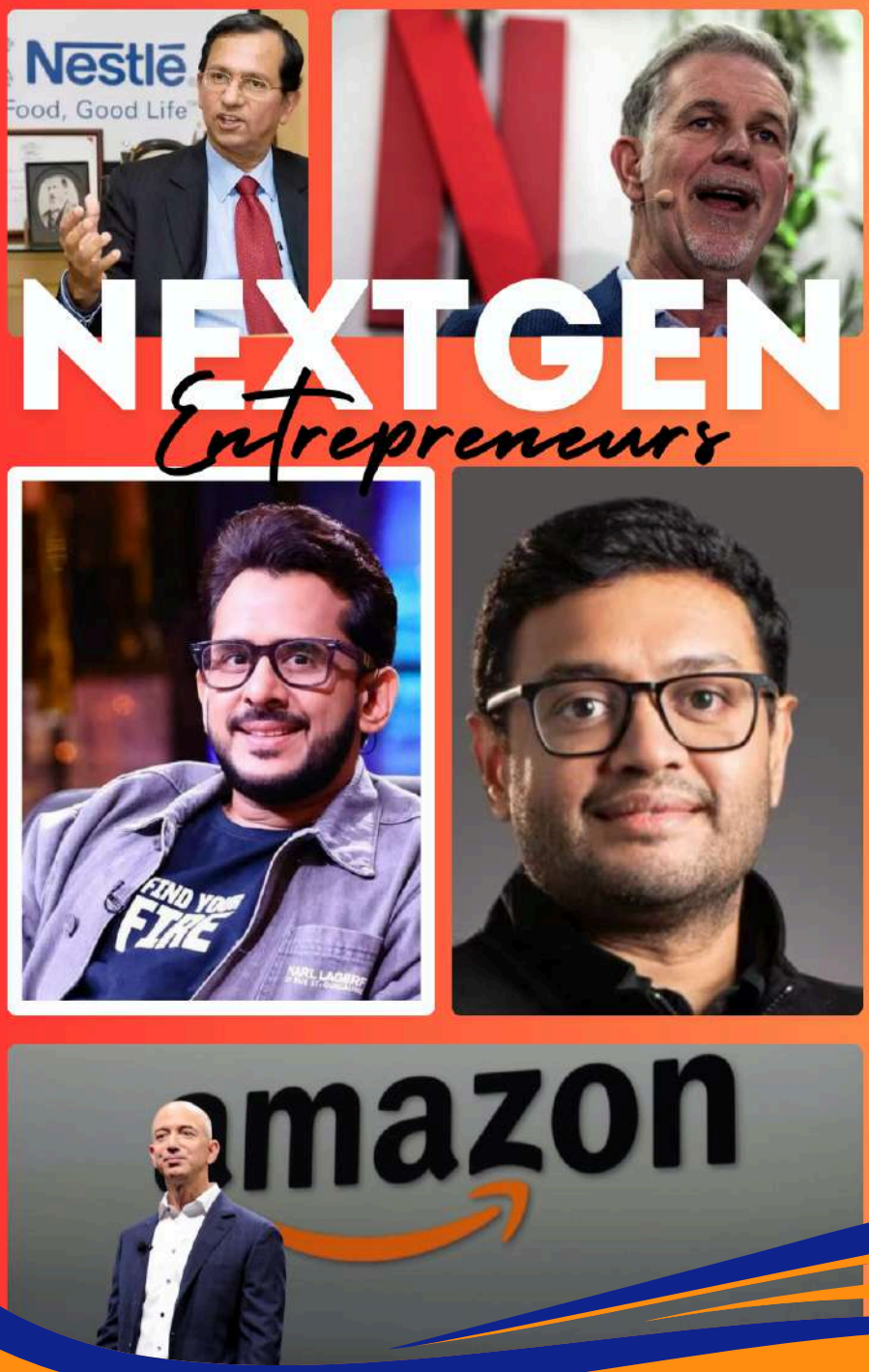
Budding Entrepreneurs Forum

JANUARY 2025

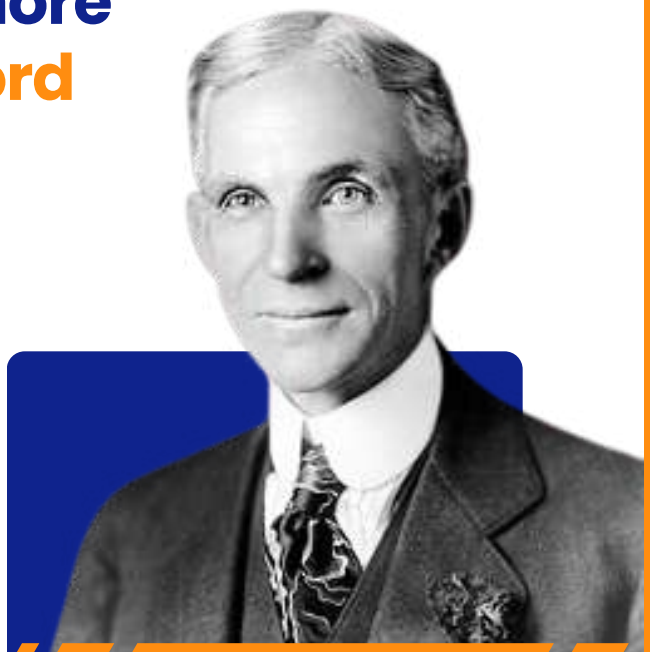
VENTURES VOYAGE

BUDDING ENTREPRENEURS FORUM



INNOVATE EMPOWER LEAD

"Failure is simply the opportunity to begin again, this time more intelligently." – Henry Ford



Henry Ford

Failure isn't just one big hindrance; instead, it's a force to be harnessed for growth. While the world relates failure with disappointment, the successful founders see that failure does not lead one to a dead end but helps in reaching one's destination of success. It is an inherent part of the journey toward doing something great. Instead of failure defining them, these entrepreneurs define it as an effective learning power, refining strategies and reshaping visions.

Behind many of the world's most successful companies is a story of early missteps, miscalculations, and struggles that, at the time, seemed like impossible obstacles. But they didn't lose; instead, they embraced the failures and used them to find lessons and insights that later became the bedrock of success. They pivoted, innovated, and evolved—challenges turned into opportunities.

In this newsletter, we'll explore how some of the biggest market leaders turned their failures into triumphs. From tech giants to consumer brands, these companies transformed initial setbacks into moments of reinvention. Their stories prove that failure isn't just a setback; it's an essential part of the process. By embracing failure, they didn't just survive—they thrived, showing the world that sometimes the greatest successes come from the greatest challenges.

Sushmita Poojari
MBA Finance

Market Leader after a tough start-Boat!

The story of boAt shows how understanding customer needs and smart planning can lead to success, even in a tough and competitive market. When Aman Gupta and Sameer Mehta launched boAt in 2016, they faced strong competition from big global brands like JBL, Sony, and Bose. Despite the challenges, they focused on what Indian consumers wanted—stylish, affordable, and durable products that suited their lifestyle.

With this insight, boAt created unique products like sweat-resistant earphones and rugged charging cables that matched the needs of Indian users. They also chose to sell their products online, which helped them keep prices low and reach a wider audience. To make their brand stand out, boAt partnered with celebrities, influencers, and sports events to build a trendy, youth-friendly image that appealed to the younger generation.

Today, boAt is India's top audio brand, loved for its innovative and affordable products. Their journey is a great example of how determination, customer focus, and creative marketing can turn a small brand into a market leader.

boAt

Vedashree Ghotkar
MBA Human Resources

Sketching Success: How Walt Disney Transformed Setbacks into a Legacy

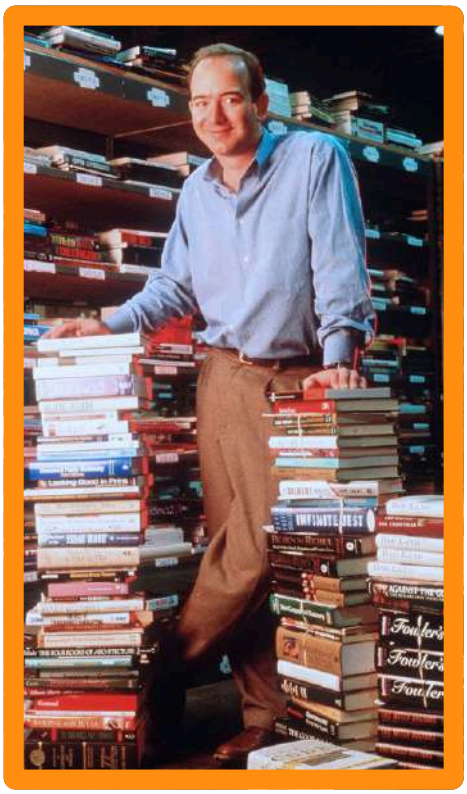
Walt Disney was indeed a genius in change, but all over his career, Walt Disney was one of the worst businessmen. Such far-out visions led to imbalanced finances that saw a good number of business failures and a ruined first studio in Laugh-o-Gram, an early collaboration on Oswald the Lucky Rabbit, which was lost when one of his distributors betrayed him by stealing his animators along with rights to the character. But already Disney was showing brilliance in making Mickey Mouse, and it became an overnight sensation. His financial sense, however, did not appear to conclude with bad ends from contracting firms like Pat Powers or with a failed experiment with feature films.

Disney dealt a heavy hand with "Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs." Costing upwards of $2 million and several years to make, the film paid off almost $7 million in return. Although it saw profit-making films like "Pinocchio" and "Bambi" crash due to such heavy money losses, the company almost went out of business during World War II. Only by creating wartime disinformation and depending largely on his brother Roy's business sense did Disney's company survive. No average was seen by him, however, in his continuing efforts in line with quality standards maintained by Disney. Finally, the result was the creation of Disneyland in 1955, which became a treasure of value to the Walter Disney Company.

All in all, it was Disney that was great due to creativity and brilliant frontal thinking quite unlike the everyday business practices. There were many mistakes on this part financially, but there was so much artistic momentum, so visionary was the management, and the outcome took the company to colossal victory with Roy standing over the revenues. Disney thus remains a great icon for creativity and determination.

Ishika Jangra
FY MBA - HR

Amazon's Rocky Start: How Persistence Turned Early Failure into Global Success



Jeff Bezos launched the company in 1994 as an online bookstore with all the skepticism of an industry still in its infancy. The idea that people would purchase books online ceased to be considered ridiculous when compared to the traditional practice of entering a physical store. The first years were plagued by some financial troubles for Amazon. In 1997, with skyrocketing sales, the company still owed quite a lot, with financial analysts asserting that it was on the brink of extinction. It was the fast expansion, with enormous money sunk into technology and other aspects, which really cost the company. The pop of the dot-com bubble in the early 2000s made it worse by sending down its stocks by around 90%.

With constant ongoing innovation and expansion forward,Amazon not only survived but created an empire that had shown persistence, adaptability, and vision could turn earlier failures into such fantastic success.

Speculators thought it wouldn't survive for long. Jeff Bezos, nevertheless, had his head focused on a long-term sustainable business model instead of a few quick dollars. Amazon hopped from electronics to clothes to almost everything one can think of. Through Prime membership, which offers speedy shipping and discounts exclusive to members of Prime, Amazon got millions of loyal customers.

Tapan Kajagar
MBA Finance

From Missteps to Mastery
The American Express Success Saga

This article recounts a real-life incident involving American Express, a globally renowned company known for its banking and transportation services.

Founded in the 19th century, American Express began as an express shipping company, transitioned into a travel agency, and eventually evolved into a global payments powerhouse, driving significant innovations along the way.

During its maturity phase, the company faced fierce competition from rivals like Visa and MasterCard. To keep up, American Express sped up its operations in 1967. Unfortunately, this led to a costly error—a payment processing mistake that impacted a customer with a staggering $11,000 mishap. Customers also struggled with poor service, long waiting times, and a lack of transparency between company representatives and clients.

Recognizing the gravity of the situation, American Express took responsibility for its shortcomings, addressed internal issues, and invested in upgrading its technology. These efforts allowed the company to improve its customer service, respond to criticism effectively, and regain trust. Despite these challenges, American Express managed to recover and sustain its strong brand value.

Garima Prasad
MBA Banking &
Finance Services

NETFLIX: FROM TRIALS TO TRIUMPH

Originally established in 1997 as a DVD rental business, Netflix today is an international entertainment company. But early hardship nearly derailed its destiny. Netflix fought against Blockbuster, a dominant force in the movie-rental industry when it was launched.

The company's subscription DVD rental service struggled to gain traction due to slow customer uptake and high operating costs. In 2000, Netflix approached Blockbuster about a partnership but the proposal was rejected, a rejection that signaled an uphill battle ahead. Netflix has turned into a digital innovation. The game changer was 2007, when the company introduced streaming systems that reduced monopoly on physical DVDs and increased viewership. Then in 2013 Netflix also decided to change the entertainment industry by investing in original content and releasing The Crown. This concept has become a pioneer in the streaming industry. Despite increasing competition and criticism for its size, Netflix is thriving today, thanks to global expansion, personalized recommendations, and movies like "Stranger Things" and "The Crown." The ability and technology to change is redefining how consumers consume content.

Netflix is thriving today, thanks to global expansion, personalized recommendations, and movies like "Stranger Things" and "The Crown." The ability and technology to change is redefining how consumers consume content.

Today, Netflix has over 200 million subscribers, surpassing the largest media companies, showcasing the transformative power of innovation and creativity.

Saanya Nair
MBA FINANCE E

Maggi's Comeback: Evolving with Health and Innovation to Reclaim Market Leadership

In 2024, Maggi, the well-known quick noodle brand from Nestlé India, ran into a big problem. Even though people had loved it for years, the brand still couldn't shake off the effects of the 2015 food safety scandal. This led to a ban and made people lose faith in the product. As more brands entered the market, Maggi started to fall behind healthier natural options that health-conscious customers preferred.

To get back on top, Maggi came out with Maggi Nutri-Licious, a new line of whole wheat noodles. These noodles had extra nutrients and didn't use artificial preservatives. They also started selling noodle cups with less salt and added veggies, aiming at busy people who wanted healthier choices.

Maggi gave its marketing plan a makeover to showcase top-notch ingredients and better-for-you options. Team-ups with chefs and social media stars introduced new recipes, sparking fresh interest among buyers. These moves soon showed results, and Maggi regained the top spot in India's instant noodle market.

Maggi's comeback in 2024 shows how a brand can change yet stay true to what it's all about. By coming up with new ideas, putting health first, and bringing its marketing up to date, Maggi won back trust and made its market position stronger.

Harsha Saraf
MBA Finance

Startups and Market Needs: Lessons from Instagrams Reel Strategy

Understanding market needs is crucial steps for every business to ensure the services or products meet customers demands and reach their target needs. This step is an ongoing process to learn the preferences of customers and adapt to it accordingly. Failure to adapt to the needs leads to decline and failure of the major startups. Instagram was one such company which adapted to market needs and used it to reach new heights

Instagram's story demonstrates that businesses that prioritize market needs, stay agile, and consistently innovate are more likely to thrive in the market.Startups that deeply understand market needs will build a strong foundation for long term success.

Tiktok with decline in the market and ban in countries like India, Australia, New zealand and many more due to legal concerns led to Instagram reels. In 2020, Instagram launched reels worldwide, to reach audiences of Tiktok or short-form videos. Reels led to an increase in downloads of Instagram to 11.8% that is 7 million to 7.8 million within a month. Users watch time increased by 3.5% and majorly was in reels.Instagram with a proper plan, continuous adaptation and new innovation to reels through filters, songs, small games etc. transformed the industry.

Varad Mulgund
MBA Business Analytics

Let's Talk Business Podcast: Swiggy IPO Panel Discussion

Welcome to first episode of **Let's Talk Business,** where we explore key industry developments shaping our world. Today's focus is on Swiggy's IPO—a major milestone for the food tech sector and Indian markets. Swiggy, a super app, offers a suite of integrated services, including food delivery, quick commerce, dining out and payment solutions. With features like live order tracking, no order value restrictions, and dynamic discoverability tailored to local business lines, Swiggy is revolutionizing convenience for both customers and partners. In this episode, we'll discuss the IPO's impact, compare it with Zomato's journey, and explore Swiggy's future opportunities and challenges.

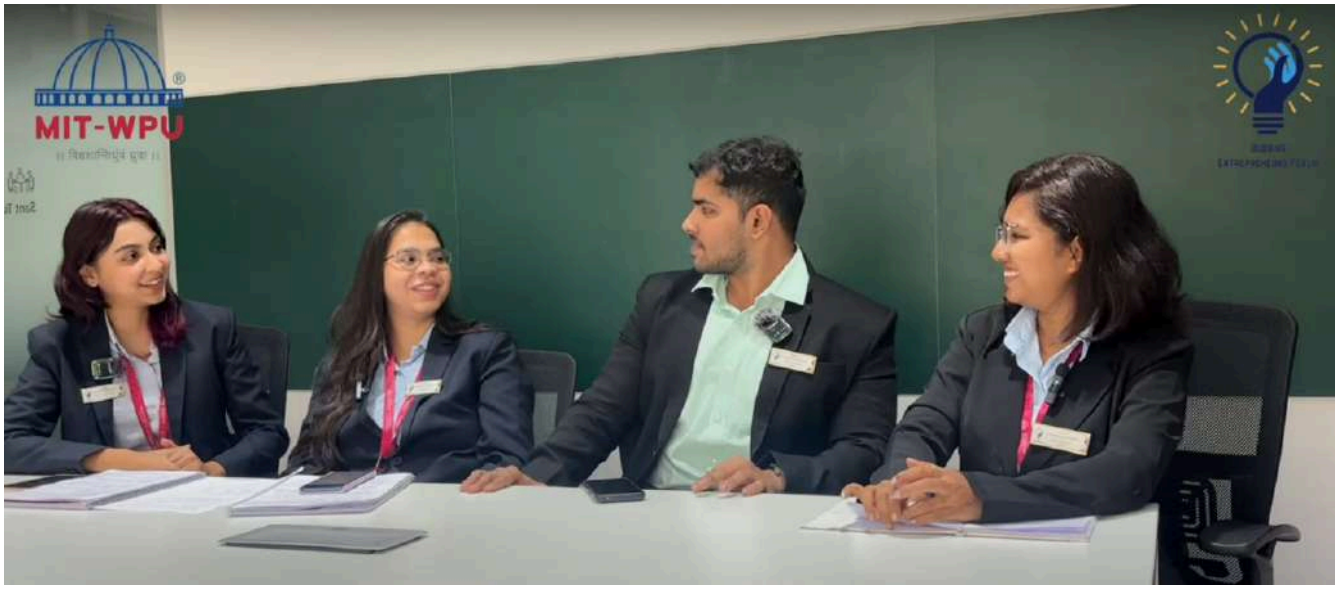
SWIGGY

• **Key points:**

- **Market Challenges:** The Nifty 50 index fell 9% before Swiggy's IPO, with subdued investor confidence impacting overall enthusiasm.
- **Financial Concerns:** Swiggy reported a net loss of ₹23.5 billion ($280 million) in FY24, compared to Zomato's profit of ₹3.5 billion. This raised questions about Swiggy's path to profitability.
- **Competitive Edge**: While Swiggy holds 34% market share, its investments in quick commerce (Instamart) are positioning it as a strong competitor to Zomato, which leads with 58% market share.

SWIGGY IPO OVERVIEW

Swiggy's IPO in November 2024 raised $1.4 billion, making it the second-largest IPO in India that year. Despite its 3x oversubscription, the offering reflected cautious investor sentiment due to weak market conditions and Swiggy's profitability concerns. Swiggy's successful market debut reflects robust investor confidence in India's burgeoning quick commerce and food delivery sectors, despite prevailing market volatility. The company's strategic focus on expanding its rapid delivery services positions it favorably against competitors like Zomato, which has also shown significant market growth since its IPO in 2021.



Hosts: Varad Mulgund, Revti Vakundakar, Akshara Sinha, and Urja Wadgaye

Topic: Swiggy IPO – Insights, Impacts, and Future Prospects

Closing Remarks

Swiggy's IPO is a pivotal moment, highlighting both its potential and challenges. Whether it can sustain growth and compete with Zomato remains to be seen.

"What's your opinion on Swiggy's IPO? Will it redefine the food delivery landscape?"

Stay tuned to Let's Talk Business for more industry insights, and don't forget to like, share, and subscribe!

• Swiggy vs. Zomato IPO

The panel compared Swiggy's IPO to Zomato's debut in 2021, revealing critical differences:

- **Market Timing:** Zomato's IPO rode the wave of a bull market, oversubscribing 40x, while Swiggy launched during a downturn, oversubscribing just 3x.
- **Valuation and Growth:** Swiggy's $10.8 billion valuation at listing was higher than Zomato's pre-listing value, but investor enthusiasm remained cautious due to Swiggy's losses.
- **Business Focus:** Zomato's core strength lies in food delivery, while Swiggy is diversifying into quick commerce through Instamart, contributing 30% of its revenue in FY24.

• Future Opportunities and Challenges

- **Expansion Strategies:** Penetrating tier-2 and tier-3 cities, tapping into underutilized markets, and expanding cloud kitchen operations.
- **Cost Optimization:** Reducing delivery costs with AI-driven logistics and enhancing operational efficiency.

Maggi became the center of controversy during the 2015 lead case, where safety concerns were raised. It made its comeback by reforming its product, re-engaging customers, and restoring its market dominance.

Similarly, Amazon joined the e-commerce wave early by starting as an online bookstore and later evolving into an e-commerce leader through expanded product offerings and innovative services.

Conclusion

The revival of failing companies can be a rare occurrence, but Maggi, Instagram Reels, and Netflix have proven how revival can lead to dominance in a market segment.

Continuous adaptation to current market trends, understanding consumer preferences, and incorporating innovative practices—while predicting and seizing future opportunities—can provide a competitive edge in the market.

These companies have emerged as forefront leaders, thriving in the market and achieving dominance after their revival stages. These tales of trials, persistence, and revival have become a blueprint for the next generation of entrepreneurs.

Sanjana Kashyap
FY MBA - HR

SUCCESS STORIES

Airbnb: Rejected Multiple Times

» Setback: Airbnb's founders faced rejection from investors over 10 times. In the initial days, they struggled to gain users and make ends meet. To fund their start-up, they even sold custom cereal boxes during the 2008 U.S. presidential election.

» Comeback: The company focused on creating trust among users by implementing safety measures and simplifying its platform. Now, Airbnb is a multibillion-dollar company that disrupted the hospitality industry.

Apple: Near Bankruptcy to Market Leader

» Setback: In the 1990s, Apple was on the brink of bankruptcy. Internal conflicts, poor product launches, and declining market share nearly caused its downfall.

» Comeback: Steve Jobs returned to Apple in 1997, cut down unprofitable product lines, and focused on innovation. The launch of the iMac, iPod, iPhone, and App Store transformed Apple into a technology and innovation leader. Today, Apple is the world's most valuable company, worth over $3 trillion.

Tesla: Bankruptcy to EV Dominance

» Setback: Tesla faced severe financial difficulties in its early years, with Elon Musk admitting the company was close to bankruptcy during the 2008 financial crisis.

» Comeback: Through relentless innovation, cost-cutting, and securing funding, Tesla launched the Model S in 2012, which gained widespread acclaim. Today, Tesla is the leader in the electric vehicle market, with a valuation exceeding $800 billion.

Slack: Failed Game to Billion-Dollar Start-up

» Setback: Before Slack, the company created a game called Glitch, which failed to attract players, forcing its shutdown.

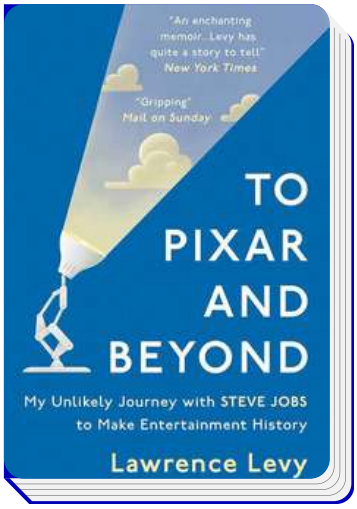
» Comeback: The team pivoted to use an internal communication tool they had developed during game development. This became Slack, which revolutionized workplace communication. Slack was acquired by Salesforce for $27 billion in 2021.

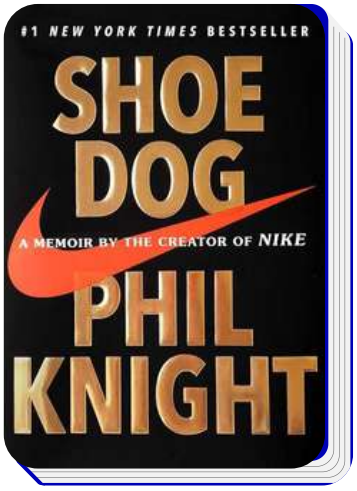
Samiksha Pazare
MBA Finance

Suggestion box: Learn from Comebacks

Two books and two courses to ignite your spirit and equip you with strategies to thrive in the face of adversity.

Books:





1. "To Pixar and Beyond" by Lawrence Levy
Pixar comes from a near-failure journey-to-global success.

2. "Shoe Dog" by Phil Knight
Tells how perseverance builds a global brand.

Courses:

1.How to Become a Better Failure: Learning to Fail Forward (Linkedin Learning) - Accept failure and learn to pivot better.

2.The Lean Startup (Udemy) - Hands-on learning on bouncing back and innovating.

Manali Khadilkar
MBA Human Resources

RIDDLES

1. I'm the spark of your success, a strategy so grand,
I balance your earnings with a steady hand.
I show you what's lost and what's in store,
Without me, your business might not soar.
What am I?

2.I'm a force that sets things in motion,
A clear path ahead with a strong devotion.
From your dreams to reality, I pave the way,
Without me, confusion would sway.
What am I?

3.I'm your bridge to the world, always in style,
I make customers linger, if only for a while.
From the shelves to their hearts, I lead the quest,
Without me, your products may not impress.
What am I?

4.I'm the shield for your brand, your safeguard tight,
With rules and laws, I defend your right.
I ensure your work is never misused,
Without me, your ownership is confused.
What am I?

5.I'm the glue that binds the team so strong,
Where everyone knows they belong.
Collaboration thrives, ideas unite,
Without me, progress takes flight.
What am I?

6.I'm the stage for your story, bold and bright,
Through videos and posts, I shine the light.
I make your business seen and heard,
Without me, you'd just be a word.
What am I?

ANSWERS:

1. Accounting
2. Planning
3. Packaging
4. Intellectual Property
5. Teamwork
6. Social Media

Nishant Inamdar
MBA FY - IB

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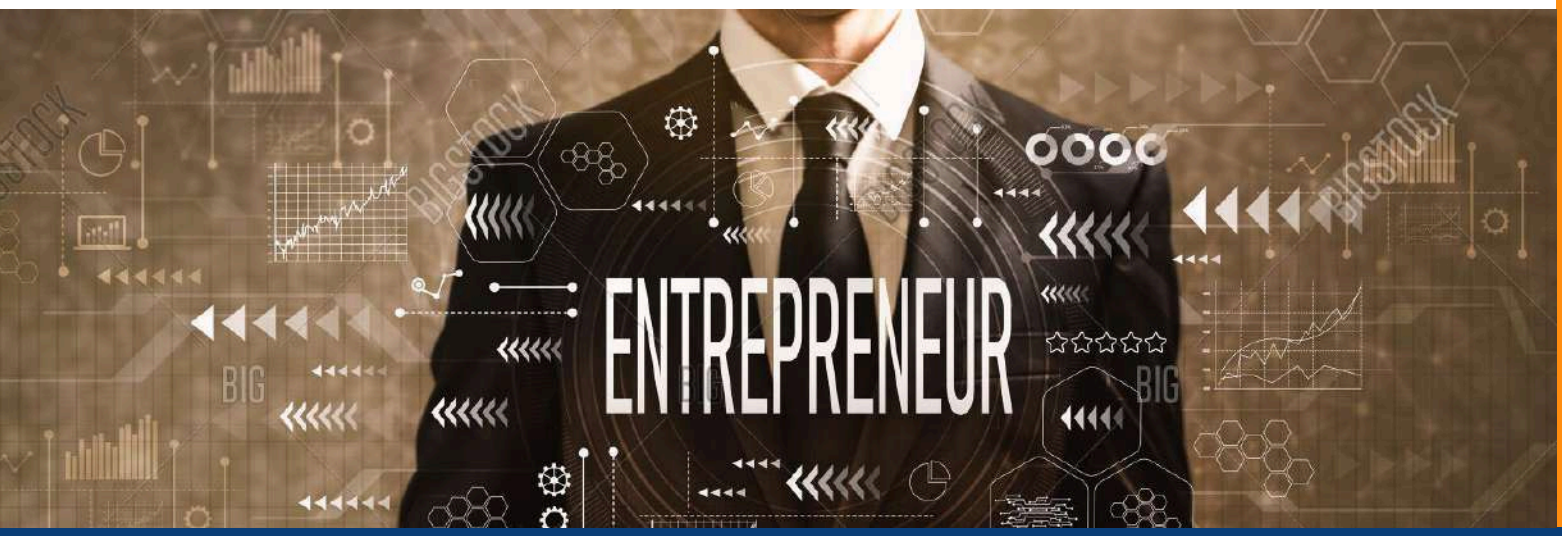

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